

The Cost of James

Platform subscriptions for delivering software — current state and future state
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Executive summary

James runs two live delivery stacks: **YBT** (SvelteKit on Vercel Pro, Supabase, Claude API, Stripe planned) and the **Jewel portal** (Azure), with automation currently on n8n and 100+ repositories on GitHub's free plan. Fixed subscription spend today is roughly **£505 per month (~£6,060/yr)**, before Azure consumption and Claude API usage. Around **88% of that fixed spend is the three Anthropic Max 20x seats (£444/mo)** — the engine of the delivery model, but also the single biggest lever if it ever needs pulling.

The future state adds low-cost distribution memberships (Apple Developer ~£6.60/mo equivalent, Google Play £19 one-off), switches Stripe on as a percentage-of-revenue cost rather than a fixed fee, and retires n8n (–£21/mo) as its workflows migrate into Azure and Supabase native features. Net effect: **fixed costs stay broadly flat (~£495/mo)** while the variable Claude API line is allowed to grow — deliberately — because in the YBT credits model, API spend is a cost of goods sold that should only rise when paying usage rises.

	Fixed £/mo	Variable
Current state	~£505	Azure consumption + Claude API (small today)
Future state	~£495	Azure + Claude API scaling with revenue + Stripe 1.5% + 20p per transaction

FX assumption throughout: \$1 ≈ £0.74 (£1 ≈ \$1.35); €1 ≈ £0.86. USD/EUR-billed items will move with exchange rates.

1 · Current state — what we pay today

Platform	Plan / basis	Billed	£/mo equiv.	Role & notes
Anthropic Max ×3	Max 20x, 3 subscriptions	\$600/mo	£444	Core delivery capability (Claude Code across projects). Largest line by far.
Vercel	Pro, 1 seat	\$20/mo	£15	YBT hosting/deployment (confirmed Pro from project config).
Supabase	Pro assumed — confirm	\$25/mo	£18	YBT auth + Postgres. Enable the Supabase connector in this chat and I'll reconcile actual orgs/projects/plan.
n8n	Starter (assumed), cloud	~€24/mo	£21	Automation workflows. Marked for retirement — see future state.
Azure (Jewel portal)	Consumption-based	varies	TBC	Jewel portal hosting. Need the actual monthly figure from Azure Cost Management to complete the picture.
Claude API	Pay-as-you-go	varies	usage	Powers YBT agents (Haiku default, admin-switchable). Small today; designed to grow with product success.
GitHub	Free plan, 100+ repos	\$0	£0	Includes 2,000 Actions minutes/mo for private repos (public repos: free minutes don't apply). No paid plan yet.
123 Reg domains	Several product domains	~£50/yr	~£4	yourbusiness.today + product domains. Estimate — renewal prices vary by TLD.
Fixed total (known)			~£505	Plus Azure consumption and Claude API usage.

Where the money goes: Anthropic Max seats ≈ 88p in every fixed £1. Everything else — hosting, database, automation, domains — fits inside the remaining ~£60/mo.

2 · Future state — add, keep, drop

Add (needed for where the products are going)

Item	Cost	£/mo equiv.	When & why
Stripe	1.5% + 20p per UK card txn	% of revenue	Needed now for YBT credit packs. No fixed fee — scales with sales (EU cards 2.5%, international 3.25%; +0.5% if using Stripe Billing).
Apple Developer Program	£79/yr	£6.60	Only when an iOS app is ready to ship — don't start the clock early; it's annual and recurring.
Google Play Console	\$25 one-off	£19 once	One-time, cheap — can register any time; note new personal accounts need a 12-tester/14-day closed test before production.
Transactional email	£0 → ~£15/mo	£0–15	Watchlist: Supabase's built-in auth email isn't for production volume. Resend/Postmark free tiers first, paid as YBT signups grow.

Item	Cost	£/mo equiv.	When & why
GitHub Team (contingency)	\$4/user/mo	£3–6	Only if private-repo Actions minutes (2,000/mo free) run out across 100+ repos. Alternative: pay-as-you-go minutes at ~\$0.006–0.008/min.

Keep (earning their place)

Item	Verdict
Anthropic Max ×3 + API	Keep — this is the production line. Review seat count only if delivery capacity needs change. Expect and budget for API growth: it's COGS in the credits model, so set a gross-margin target per credit rather than a spend cap.
Vercel Pro	Keep — right-sized at one seat. Watch bandwidth/function overages as YBT traffic grows.
Supabase	Keep and lean in — auth, Postgres, storage, edge functions, cron and queues replace whole categories of other subscriptions. Keep the spend cap ON until Stripe revenue is live.
Azure	Keep for Jewel portal — and it absorbs n8n's job (Logic Apps / Functions). Set a budget alert now so consumption growth is a decision, not a surprise.
GitHub Free	Keep free as long as possible; it's doing the work of a paid plan today.
123 Reg domains	Keep — trivial cost; consolidate renewals annually and watch first-year-price traps on new product domains.

Drop (planned exits)

Item	Saving	Exit route
n8n	~£21/mo (~£250/yr)	Migrate workflows to Azure Logic Apps/Functions (Jewel side) and Supabase edge functions + cron + webhooks (YBT side). Cancel once the last workflow moves — no exit penalty on monthly billing.

3 · The variable line — Claude API growth scenarios

YBT charges credits (10/reply, 50/ingest) and the API bill follows paying usage. That makes API spend the one line that *should* grow. Indicative planning bands, assuming the Haiku-default model mix:

Scenario	Indicative API £/mo	What it means
Today — early access	£10–40	Light usage, testing, demos. Absorb into overheads.
Traction	£75–£300	Regular paying users. Credit pricing must clear API cost + Stripe fees with margin.
Product success	£400–£1,500+	At this point consider API volume discounts/committed spend, prompt caching, and model-mix tuning (Haiku vs Sonnet) as the margin levers.

Rule of thumb: if the API line grows faster than credit revenue, the unit economics need retuning — not the usage capping.

4 · Recommendations

- 1. Confirm the two unknowns.** Enable the Supabase connector in this chat (it's installed on your account, just toggled off) so I can list actual projects and plans, and pull the Jewel portal's monthly figure from Azure Cost Management. Those are the only two numbers standing between this review and a complete picture.
- 2. Sequence the additions.** Stripe when YBT payments go live (it costs nothing until revenue flows). Google Play's £19 any time. Apple's £79/yr only when an iOS build is actually ready.
- 3. Run the n8n exit as a project.** List its workflows, map each to Azure or Supabase, migrate, cancel. Small saving, but it also removes a platform to secure, update and think about.
- 4. Protect the downside.** Azure budget alerts, Supabase spend cap on, GitHub Actions usage checked monthly. All free, all five minutes.
- 5. Review the Max seats quarterly.** £444/mo is the right spend while three seats' worth of delivery is happening. Make it a deliberate quarterly decision rather than a standing order.

Assumptions & to confirm

Supabase on Pro at \$25/mo (could be Free — confirm via connector) · n8n on Starter monthly (~€24) · domain renewals ~£50/yr total · FX \$1=£0.74, €1=£0.86 · Azure consumption excluded pending actuals · Claude API bands are planning estimates, not quotes · all list prices checked August 2026 and subject to change.

Sources

Anthropic Max pricing (Max 5x \$100 / Max 20x \$200): intuitionlabs.ai, cloudzero.com · Supabase Pro \$25/Team \$599: costbench.com, makerkit.dev · Vercel Pro \$20/user: comparedge.com, flexprice.io · n8n Starter €20–24/Pro €50: n8n.io/pricing · GitHub Free/Team \$4 & 2,000 Actions min: github.com/pricing · Apple Developer £79/yr (\$99): magora-systems.com, payoutmath.co.uk · Google Play \$25 one-off: support.google.com, iconikai.com · Stripe UK 1.5% + 20p: wearefounders.uk, finexer.com · FX: x-rates.com.